METRIC
A-A-52039C
August 21, 2025
SUPERSEDING
A-A-52039B
September 15, 1995

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

# LUBRICATING OIL, AUTOMOTIVE ENGINE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This Commercial Item Description (CID) describes lubricating oils meeting the American Petroleum Institute (API) service category SQ (Resource Conserving) and bearing the API certification mark, as defined by the API Engine Oil Licensing & Certification System (EOCLS). These oils are suitable for lubricating spark-ignition gasoline engines typically used in administrative and commercial vehicles.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The lubricating oil shall conform to the following viscosity grades:

2.1 Viscosity grades. SAE 5W-20, SAE 5W-30, and SAE 10W-30

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Performance. Lubricating oils shall meet the requirements of API category SQ (Resource Conserving), as defined in API 1509, and bear the API service symbol ("donut") and certification mark.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, and any data that may improve this document should be sent to: U.S. Army Ground Vehicle Systems Center, ATTN: FCDD-GVR-VMT, MS#263, 6501 E. 11 Mile Road, Warren, MI 48397-5000, or emailed to usarmy.detroit.devcom-gvsc.mbx.standardization@army.mil.

FSC 9150

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3.2 Physical and chemical requirements. Lubricating oils shall meet all physical and chemical property requirements for API category SQ (Resource Conserving) and the appropriate viscosity grade as defined in SAE J300. Additionally, measured values per the ASTM test procedure for all properties in Table I shall be submitted to the contracting officer at the time of solicitation and may be used for product and shelf-life verification testing.

TABLE I. Physical and chemical properties of lubricating oils.

| Property | ASTM Test Procedure |
|---|---|
| Pour point, °C | D97, D5949, or D5950 |
| Flash point, °C | D92 |
| Acid Number, mg KOH/g | D664 |
| Base Number, mg KOH/g | D2896 |

3.3 Proof of licensing. The Contractor shall certify that the lubricating oils to be delivered are covered by a valid API license, in accordance with Sections 3.1 and 3.2. The Contractor shall provide the contracting officer with a copy of the API license or certificate for the lubricating oils.

## 4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 Hazard communication standard. The contractor shall certify that no carcinogenic or potentially carcinogenic constituents are present as defined under the Hazard Communication Standard (29 CFR 1910.1200). The contractor shall provide certification to this effect to the contracting officer.

4.2 Toxicity. Lubricating oils supplied under this CID shall have no adverse effect on the health of personnel when used for their intended purpose. Questions pertinent to this effect shall be referred by the contracting activity to the appropriate departmental medical service who will act as an advisor to the contracting agency. The contractor shall have the Safety Data Sheet (SDS) information available for review by the contracting activity to evaluate the safety of the material for proposed use.

4.3 Recovered materials. The offer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

## 5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this CID, and that the product conforms to the producers own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.



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5.2 Market acceptability (MA). The contractor shall provide products which have a proven market record based on the number of items sold, length of time the product has been on the market, and reliability and performance.

5.3 Inspection and testing. The inspection and testing of products to be supplied under this CID shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. PACKAGING.

Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Addresses for obtaining copies of referenced documents.

7.1.1 API. Copies of API 1509 “Engine Oil Licensing and Certification System” are available at https://www.api.org/products-and-services/engine-oil/documents/api-1509-documents.

7.1.2 ASTM. Copies of ASTM test standards and procedures cited in this document can be ordered from http://www.astm.org.

7.1.3 CFR. Copies of 29 CFR 1910.1200 may be obtained at https://www.osha.gov/laws-regs/regulations/standardnumber.

7.1.4 SAE. Copies of SAE J300 can be ordered at http://www.sae.org.

7.2 Changes from previous issue. Changes from previous issue. Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensive changes.

7.3 Key words.

SAE 5W-20
SAE 5W-30
SAE 10W-30



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## CONCLUDING MATERIAL

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army – AT
Navy – SH
Air Force – 68
DLA – GS

Review activities:
Army – CD, MD1, SM
Navy – AS, MC, OS, SA, YD
DLA – PS

Industry associations:
ASTM
SAE

CVILIAN AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY
GSA-FAS

Preparing Activity:
Army – AT
(Project Number 9150-2025-006)



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